put together by the Hoover Institution at Stanford University and edited by nuclear scholars Sumit Ganguly and Dinsha Mistree, Rice and a host of other key interlocutors, both American and Indian, share insights on how they had to break many taboos, including removing the massive sanctions and prohibitions imposed by earlier US presidents that had made India a nuclear pariah. US president Bill Clinton had tightened the noose in 1998 after India conducted five nuclear weapons tests to add to the first in 1974.

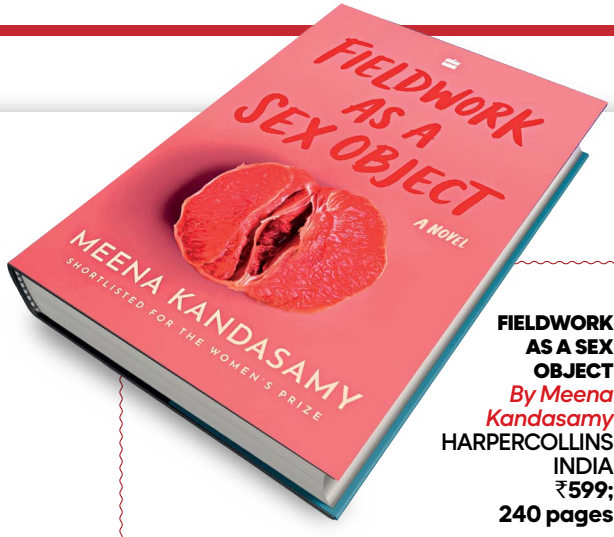
In her preface, Condoleezza Rice reveals how **BUSH REGARDED INDIA AS A MATURE DEMOCRACY** and thought it high time to discard America's adversarial approach

In her preface to the book, Rice reveals how Bush regarded India as a mature democracy and, unlike Clinton, thought it high time to discard America's adversarial approach. The Bush administration, in its second term, worked hard to bring India on par in terms of privileges with other nuclear weapons states, including allowing it to import hitherto banned nuclear material and equipment. In doing so, the deal became the crowning foreign policy achievement of both Bush and PM Dr Manmohan Singh.

The value of the book lies in bringing together principal interlocutors from both sides to share first-hand accounts of the tough negotiations preceding the deal that had on occasions needed Bush and Manmohan Singh to expend enormous political capital to bring it to fruition. Former foreign secretary Shyam Saran, former Atomic Energy Commission chairman Anil Kakodkar, disarmament expert Rakesh Sood, national security advisors M.K. Narayanan and Shivshankar Menon provide fascinating perspectives on India's approach.

For the US, apart from Rice, two distinguished former US ambassadors, David Mulford and Ken Juster, and Jonah Blank, a former aide to then senator Joe Biden, reveal the energy-sapping battles the Bush administration fought to get the Congressional approval necessary to close the deal. With the Modi government removing the last impediment to US-India civil nuclear cooperation by passing the Shanti (Sustainable Harnessing and Advancement of Nuclear Energy for Transforming India) Act 2025, India has finally fulfilled its part of the bargain. Though it took a decade and a half, better late than never. ■

—Raj Chengappa



FIELDWORK AS A SEX OBJECT
By Meena Kandasamy
HARPERCOLLINS INDIA
₹599; 240 pages

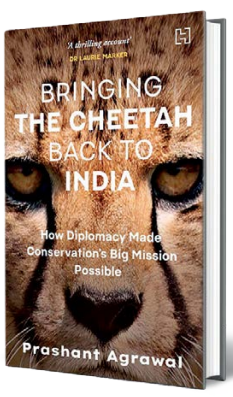
Sex, Lies and Video Fakes

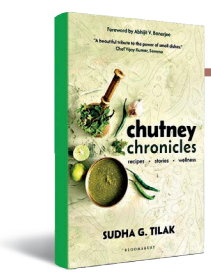
Meena Kandasamy's tantalisingly titled novel explores several seminal issues through the story of Amrita Chaturvedi, a Delhiite based in London, whose life falls apart when a deepfake pornographic video featuring her goes viral.

CALL OF THE WILD

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BLOOMSBURY INDIA
₹499; 224 pages

TANGY TALES

Sudha G. Tilak is a blue-blooded chutneyphile, truly passionate about this quintessentially Indian condiment. A notebook with 30 chutney recipes written in Tamil, a gift from her mother a decade ago, served as the springboard for this lovingly researched book that provides history, mystery and much context besides eminently practical recipes.

*—Compiled by **Amit Dixit***